RICHARD ORELLANA

Senior Full-Stack Software Engineer | Backend-Heavy | TypeScript / Node.js | Agentic AI & Modernization

richard.o2188@gmail.com | +593 987 478 246 | Quito, Ecuador | linkedin.com/in/richard-orellana-071b95163 | github.com/ItsMeRichArt

Based in Ecuador (UTC-5 year-round) | Remote collaboration with U.S. teams

Professional Summary

Senior software engineer developing software since 2011 and working with Node.js since 2017. Strong in backend systems, distributed services, API design, and integrations. Currently delivering AI-enabled customer-support workflows for Swap and contributing to enterprise modernization for Paciolan, combining React/TypeScript micro-frontends, cloud microservices, and custom Claude Code agentic-AI tooling. Experience spans technical discovery, implementation, automated quality gates, deployment, and production ownership.

Core Technical Skills

Languages & backend: TypeScript, JavaScript (ES2022), Node.js, Python, FastAPI, Django, Django REST Framework, Java (legacy), NestJS, Express.js, REST APIs, microservices, Domain-Driven Design, event-driven systems, WebSockets/Socket.io.

Frontend, data & integrations: React, micro-frontends, Vue (working knowledge), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Sequelize, Redis, indexing, caching, Shopify, Front, Yotpo, third-party APIs.

Agentic AI & delivery: Claude Code, custom plugins and skills, specialized subagents, Model Context Protocol (MCP), AI-assisted discovery, code generation, automated review and QA gates; Cursor, Codex, Gemini, Jest, Mocha/Chai, Docker, Kubernetes, AWS, GitLab CI/CD, Bitbucket Pipelines, CDN deployments.

Professional Experience

Sr. Software Engineer — Full-Stack (Backend-Heavy) | Full Stack Labs | Jun 2024 – Present | Remote (U.S.)

Client: Swap — AI-powered e-commerce and customer-support platform; customer support (CS) widget for merchants, shoppers, and support teams.

- AI customer-support widget: Built production backend APIs and agent-facing workflows that provide contextual assistance inside merchant storefronts; delivered features from design and implementation through tests, UAT, release, monitoring, and troubleshooting.
- Human-agent escalation & conversation persistence: Developed escalation flows and conversation-state handling to preserve support context between automated assistance and human teams; validated handoff scenarios and edge cases in QA/UAT.
- Front integration: Connected AI support conversations with Front so merchant support teams can handle escalations in their existing tools; investigated integration failures and verified cross-service behavior.
- Shopify & conversational commerce: Implemented and maintained discount, checkout, and shopping interactions exposed through the CS widget, handling third-party API boundaries and workflow edge cases.
- Yotpo loyalty integration: Integrated loyalty-related capabilities into conversational customer journeys; verified platform responses and error paths.
- Storefront widget & delivery: Contributed customer-facing components, cross-repository changes, and CDN asset delivery for embedded merchant storefront experiences.
- Analytics & reliability: Improved analytics caching, session management, persistence, and billing safeguards; addressed production issues and worked with Product and QA to turn merchant feedback into stable releases.

Client: Paciolan — Enterprise platform modernization and AI-assisted migration.

- Legacy modernization: Modernize a legacy enterprise application into React/TypeScript micro-frontends and cloud-based microservices built with Node.js, Express, NestJS, and Python/FastAPI. Own cross-stack features from technical discovery and UI implementation to API design, integration, testing, and production release.
- Custom agentic-AI engineering: Build reusable Claude Code plugins, skills, and specialized subagents with MCP integrations to support large-scale migration work. Encode project conventions and migration patterns into repeatable workflows for codebase discovery, legacy-to-modern implementation planning, code generation, and developer assistance.
- AI-driven quality controls: Orchestrate agent-assisted code reviews and QA gates to check architectural consistency, identify integration risks, and surface regressions before release. Review and validate generated changes through engineering judgment, automated tests, and normal review practices rather than treating AI output as production-ready by default.
- Microservices architecture: Designed and delivered a greenfield TypeScript/Node.js and Express ecosystem, reducing inter-service latency by ~35% versus the prior monolith and supporting independent deployments for 5 domain teams.
- Service security & data performance: Implemented service-to-service JWT authentication across 8 APIs, supporting a first-attempt SOC 2 audit; optimized PostgreSQL/MongoDB schemas and indexes to cut average query times by 28%.
- Cloud delivery & mentoring: Containerized services with Docker/Kubernetes and automated GitLab CI/CD, reducing infrastructure provisioning from 2 days to under 2 hours; mentored 2 engineers as unit test coverage improved from 42% to 87% in one quarter.

Sr. Software Engineer — Backend | Intive | Nov 2022 – Aug 2024 | Remote (New York, U.S.)

- Built Socket.io services supporting 10,000+ concurrent WebSocket connections at sub-100ms latency, enabling a product tier generating $400K ARR.
- Re-engineered a Node.js/PostgreSQL/Sequelize pipeline, decreasing average API response time from 850ms to 190ms as measured in production dashboards.
- Introduced integration tests and GitLab CI/CD, reducing release cycles from 2 weeks to 3 days and production incidents by 40%; containerized services for horizontal scaling and eliminated 3 recurring outages.

- Collaborated with U.S. stakeholders across CST/PST and delivered sprint commitments for 18 consecutive months.

Sr. Software Developer | Philip Morris International | Oct 2017 – Oct 2022 | Quito, Ecuador

- Owned the e-commerce backend across Ecuador, Colombia, and Peru, processing $2M+ in annual transactions with zero P1 incidents during a five-year tenure.
- Integrated 6 payment, logistics, and CRM APIs, reducing manual order-processing time 65% and enabling same-day tracking.
- Built Docker environments and Bitbucket CI/CD, reducing developer setup from 3 days to 4 hours and increasing deployment frequency from monthly to weekly.
- Served as hybrid tech lead/project owner for a 6-person team; mentored 4 junior engineers, 2 of whom advanced to mid-level within 18 months.

IT Software Analyst | Philip Morris International | Jun 2012 – Aug 2014 | Quito, Ecuador

- Created internal tools for 50+ employees across 3 countries, replacing manual spreadsheets and saving an estimated 120 person-hours per month.

Software Developer — Java Backend | Kruger Labs | Jun 2011 – Jun 2012 | Quito, Ecuador

- Delivered 3 Java EE projects using JSF, EJB, JPA, Hibernate, DB2, and Oracle.

AI Model Evaluation

AI Trainer & Code Quality Evaluator | Revelo (for Cline) | Dec 2025 – Mar 2026 | Freelance, concurrent

- Evaluated 100+ agentic coding prompts for backend correctness, architecture, and consistency; annotated multi-step reasoning failures and delivered RLHF-style feedback for model improvement.

Selected Public Code

stock-trading-platform-api: TypeScript, PostgreSQL/Prisma, Docker; trade validation, portfolios, retry logic, Winston logging.

medical-provider-verifier: TypeScript/Docker; OpenCorporates collection and LLM-assisted verification dashboard.

fuel-stop-optimizer: Python/Django REST Framework; 3-call API budget, 1-hour TTL cache, offline geocoding, 6,626-station dataset.

Education, Certifications & Languages

B.Sc. Systems Engineering & Computer Science — Escuela Politécnica del Ejército (ESPE), Quito, 2006–2011 | Full-Stack Developer Bootcamp — 4Geeks Academy, Miami, 2022

Certifications: Domain-Driven Design with NestJS & Node.js; Node.js from Scratch to Pro; Scrum Master Professional (SMPC); Product Owner Professional (SPOPC).

Languages: Spanish (native), English (C2), French (B1).